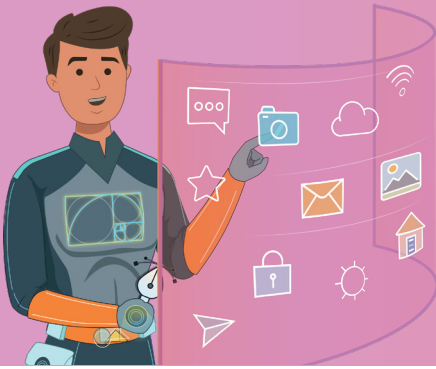
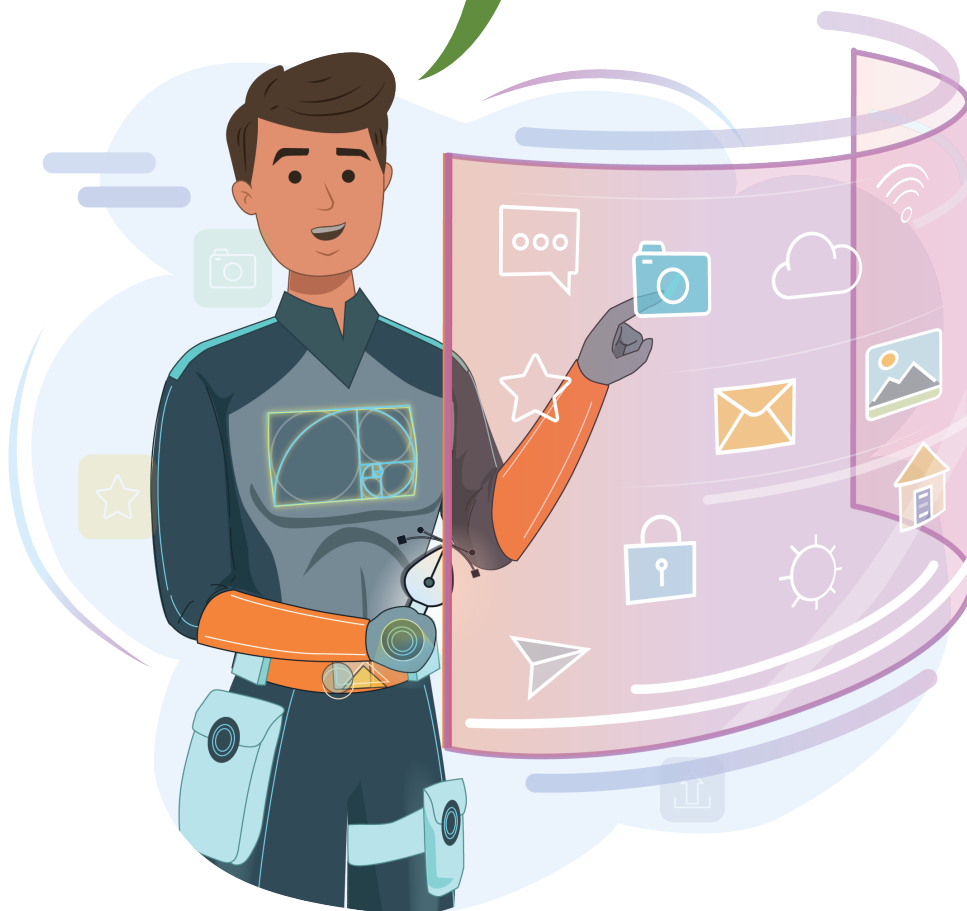




Sometimes it is hard to recollect the name of brands or apps. But we can easily identify them by their logos or icons.



In today's digital world, icons play a significant role in identifying applications. Users are generally attracted to well-designed icons. But a good icon is not just about design. It needs to describe the purpose of the application it represents.

Usually, icons are simple, clear, and easy to understand.



Sample clock icon

3. Material Design

Icons can have various styles, and each style has its own advantages.

A few examples are:

Outline icon style

Commonly called lined icons, outline icons are clean, modern and designed with thin, smooth strokes.



Glyph icon style

Glyph icons have smooth curves and simple shapes.



Doodle icon style

Doodle icons are mostly hand-drawn. They are similar to cartoons.



Flat icon style

Flat icons are similar to glyph icons, but they are coloured. Flat designs are widely used for mobile application icons.



From the above examples, we can observe that it is difficult to highlight a specific part of an icon or add shadows in flat design. We can achieve this look through Material Design.

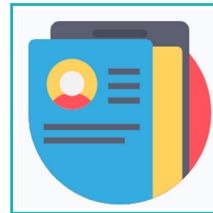
Bytes

Material Design is a design language developed by Google in 2014.

3. Material Design

Material Design is a style of flat design with simple effects used to add highlights and shadows. This elevates a graphic from its background.

Examples of material design:



An app's icon is an important element. Let's create an icon for an application which helps generate ideas.



Let's use material design to make an icon from scratch.

Activity

Create an icon for an ideation application. Ideation applications are used to generate new ideas. People can discuss and suggest ideas to solve any problems.

Ideation is a process which generates new thoughts and sheds light on possible solutions. This is what the icon should represent. So, we will choose a style that shows light in some manner.

Here are a few ideas:



Note:

Explore as many ideas as you can for an ideation app icon.

All above ideas are good, but in this case a lightbulb seems to be most suitable. We will create a bulb icon.

1 Sketch an idea

Sketch as many designs for the bulb icon as you want and choose the best one.

a. Use a paper and pencil to sketch a light bulb.

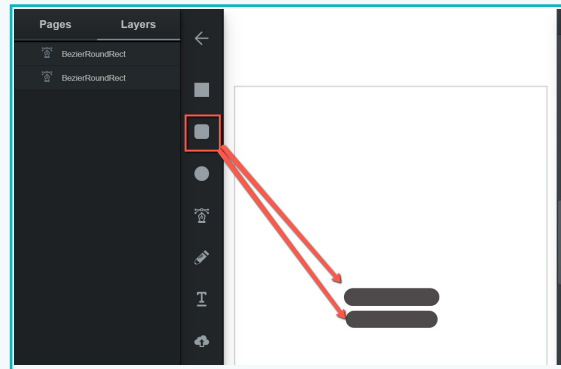


Activity

Let's use it to create a vector image.

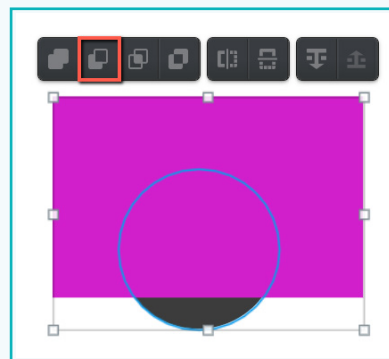
In the vector application, we will start to create from the base of the icon.

- b. For the base, we can use a rounded rectangle shape. We require two of those.



Next, let's create the lower section.

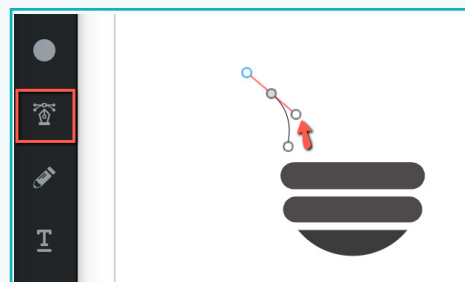
- c. Slice the circle to create the required shape.



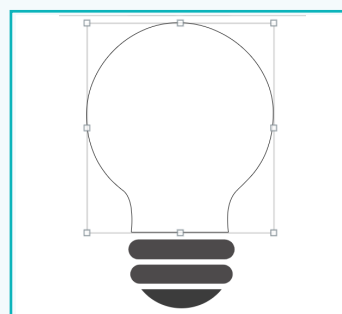
Now, to create the upper part of the bulb, we will use the pen tool.

The Pen tool allows us to create free form shapes.

- d. With the **pen tool** selected, click on the workspace to create a node. Click and drag to create a curved path.

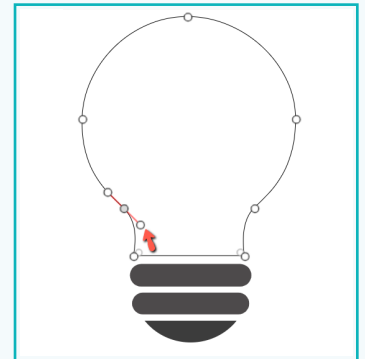


- e. Continue until the shape of the bulb is complete.

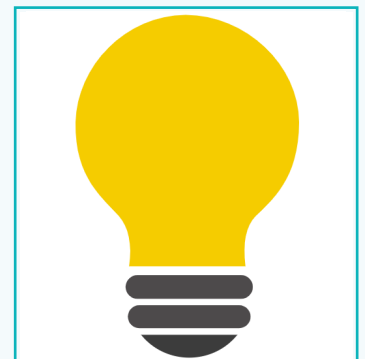


Activity

- f. Observe closely, we need to modify the curve by editing the nodes.
- g. Double click on a node to edit it.



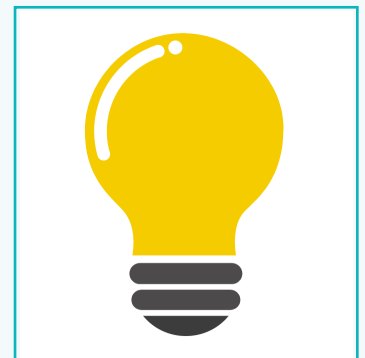
- h. Add an appropriate colour to the bulb and its base.



We will add a few details to show the bulb's form.

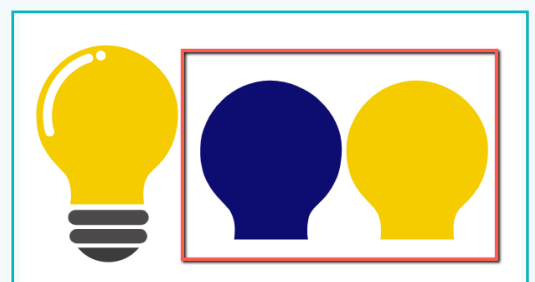
Firstly, let's add highlights.

- i. Using the pen tool, create a shape for the highlight. Colour it white.



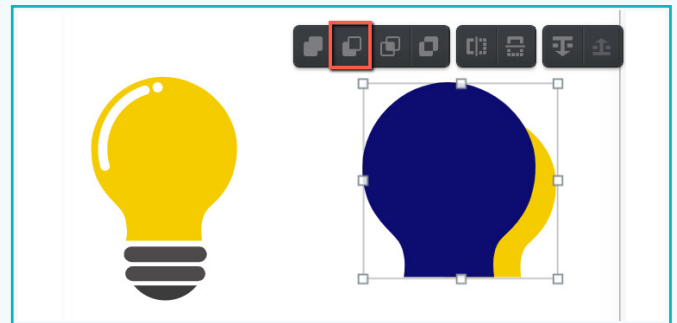
To add depth, we will create a shadow for the bulb.

- j. Duplicate the bulb shape twice. Colour one of them blue.

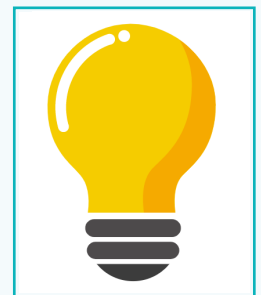
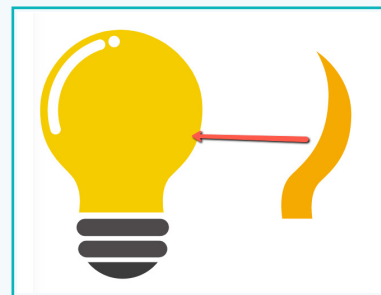


Activity

k. Increase the blue bulb's size and place it over the yellow as shown. Subtract the shape.



l. Darken the new shape's colour to make it look like a shadow. Place it on the lightbulb.



Shadows and highlights add details and depth to an object.

m. Complete the icon with a background

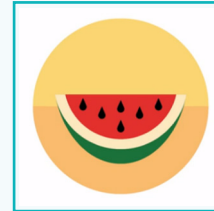
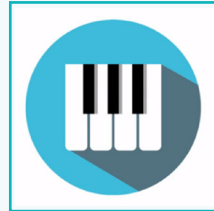
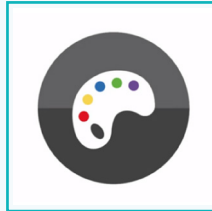


n. Add a semicircle of a darker shade to the background for more detailing.



Activity

Try to recreate these icons in the vector application.



Note:

While creating icons, highlights and shadows should be added for detail with respect to the material and form of objects.

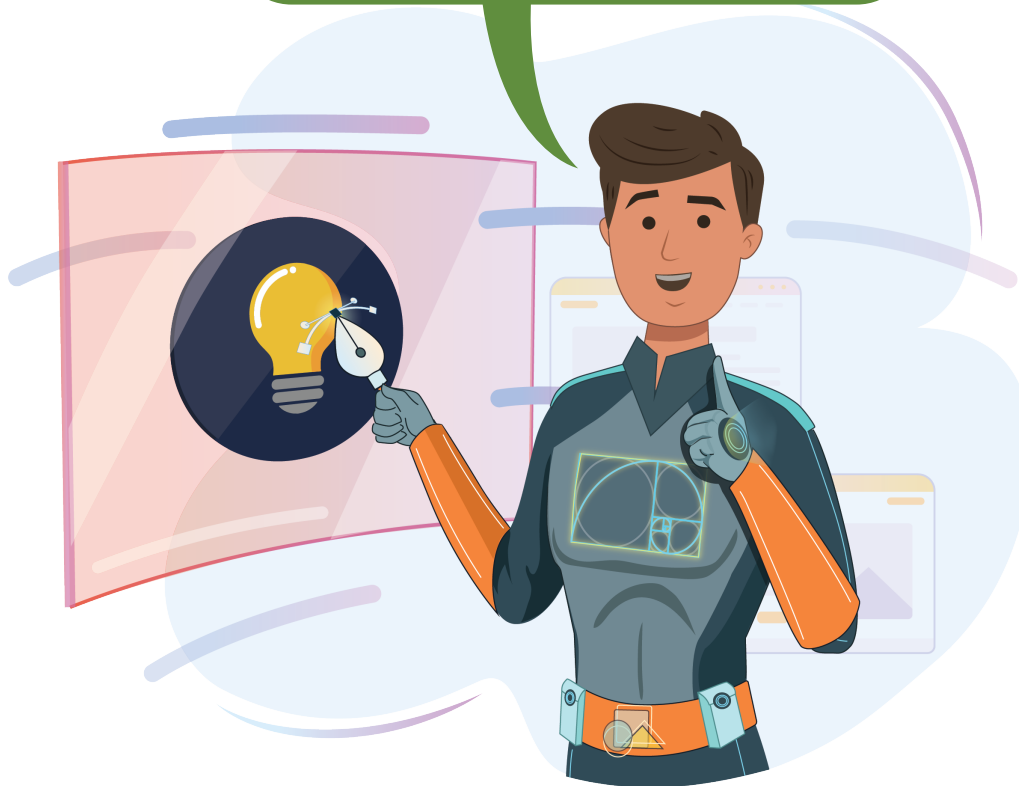
For Example: the pencil is wooden; hence it shouldn't have highlights but due to form of object it should have a shadow.

Exercise

Fill in the blanks

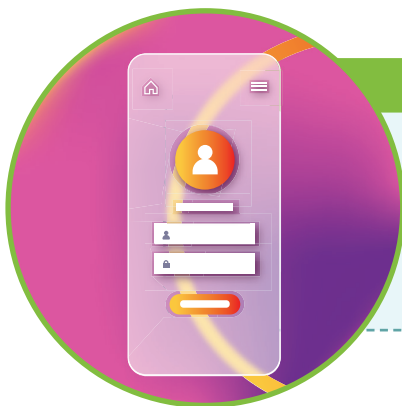
- 1 _____ is a trend derived from flat design.
- 2 _____ are designed in minimalistic forms, expressing essential characteristics.
- 3 The _____ tool allows us to create free form shapes.
- 4 Material design is a type of _____ design with simple effects used to add highlights and shadows.

When creating a logo, we must keep the brand name and expertise in mind.



Tech Flash

- **Material design** : Material Design is a style of flat design with simple effects used to add highlights and shadows.
- **Pen tool** : The pen tool allows us to create free form shapes.



Future Tech

Glassmorphism

A UI design in which the objects (light or dark) are given the most emphasis, by giving an impression of a frosted glass look is called as Glassmorphism.

